

Overview

The textual studies section for Islam refers specifically to the Qur'an.

There are two sections: Beliefs and Teachings of Islam; Lives of the Prophets and Others.

The themes and teachings of the Qur'an are explored in depth; the references within the specification should be used as a starting point in a student's textual studies and students may use other texts from the Qur'an, Hadith and other holy books within Islam to help contextualise, understand and compare the teachings and examples found below. The exploration of the lives of the prophets, and others, should recognise that these stories teach spiritual truths in addition to being stories.

Students will be expected to study Islam and the Qur'an within the context of wider British society, the religious traditions of which are, in the main, Christian. Students should recognise that Islam is one of the many religions and world views in Great Britain, which include Buddhism, Hinduism, Judaism, Sikhism and non-religious views such as Humanism and atheism. This knowledge may be applied throughout the assessment of the specified content.

Students should compare and contrast the areas of belief and practice within Islam with non-religious views.

The significance and importance of the various beliefs, issues and practices of Muslims today should be explored throughout the two sections. They should understand how varied interpretations of the meaning of passages from the Qur'an may give rise to diversity within Muslim traditions and consider how far Muslim and non-religious communities give authority to the Qur'an, especially in relation to other sources of contemporary authority.

Students should have an understanding of:

1.1	The importance of Allah in Surah al-Fatiha (1): the way Allah is described; the importance of submission to his will and the significance of this to Muslims living today.
1.2	The oneness of Allah in Surah al-Anaam (6:13–24): what this means to an understanding of Allah, how this reflected in worship; its significance for Muslims today.
1.3	The 99 beautiful names of Allah found in the Qur'an and what they teach Muslims about Allah: Ar-Rahman (the All-Merciful), including Surah 55:1; Ar-Rahim (the All-Merciful), including Surah 3:31; As-Salam (the Source of Peace), including Surah 59:23; Al-Khaliq (the Creator), including Surah 6:102; Al-Ghaffar (the All-Forgiving), including Surah 2:173; Ar-Razzaq (the Sustainer), including Surah 51:58; their importance and how they are used to illustrate understanding Allah and his relationship to humanity; and their importance for Muslims living and worshipping today.
1.4	The nature of believers in Surah al-Baqarah (2): how believers are described; the blessings that come through belief; how non-believers are described; understandings of the significance of these passages for different Muslims today.
1.5	Creation (Surah 45:3–5; 21:30; 41:11; 21:33; 51:47; 7:54; 50:38; 57:4; 71:13–17; 24:45): the events of creation; the role of Allah and humanity in the narrative; the role of humanity as vicegerent/khalifah (Surah 2:30–39); as being above the angels; the significance of these beliefs for Muslims today.
1.6	Justice (Surah An-Nisa 4:105–135): the nature and importance of justice as outlined in the Qur'an; its application in the Qur'an, in examples from the life of Muhammad in the Hadith, and divergent ways it is applied by Muslims today.
1.7	Shirk: teachings about shirk in the Qur'an and their significance; the ascribing of partners to Allah; the worship of idols, including Surah 7:148–150; divergent ways in which this belief will affect a Muslim today and their relationship to other religions.
1.8	Shari'ah law: how the Qur'an is used as the basis for Shari'ah law (Surah 4:59–60 and 33:21–36) with examples expressed in the life of Muslims today; and how Shari'ah law might be understood in divergent ways in different traditions of Islam; Muslim responses to non-religious arguments (including atheist and Humanist) which suggest that religious observance, such as following Shari'ah, can be seen to be unnecessary.